VIT BHOPAL

Name: Diya Annasaheb Poulkar

Registration Id: 25BAI10544

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Submitted To- Kannan Shanmugan

NGMC CASE STUDY

SECTION A
ESTABLISHING THE CONTEXT

Today, digital tools have become a normal part of student life. Almost every student uses platforms like Canva, Google Docs, and PowerPoint for assignments and presentations. Because of this, many students believe they are good with technology. But using tools and actually understanding them are two very different things.

Most students know how to create presentations or edit documents, but they rarely think about deeper issues like privacy, ownership of content, or how their online actions can affect their future. For example, a student might copy images from the internet without checking copyright, or share personal information without realizing the risk.

This gap exists because modern tools are designed to be easy. Templates, suggestions, and ready-made designs make work look professional without requiring much effort or understanding. As a result, students focus more on appearance than accuracy or originality.

This creates a false sense of digital confidence. Students feel skilled because they can use tools smoothly, but they may not understand the consequences of their actions. Real digital literacy

is not just about using tools — it is about thinking critically, acting responsibly, and understanding risks.

So, the main issue is not lack of usage, but lack of awareness. Students are active online, but not always responsible or informed.

SECTION B

DIGITAL IDENTITY AND ETHICS

Having an online presence on platforms like LinkedIn or GitHub is often seen as important for students today. It is believed that these platforms help students showcase their skills and get opportunities. While this is true to some extent, these platforms also create serious challenges.

In theory, these platforms give equal opportunities to everyone. Any student can create a profile and share their work. However, in reality, students who already have better guidance or resources tend to present themselves more effectively. Others may struggle even if they are equally capable. So instead of reducing inequality, these platforms sometimes make it more visible.

Another issue is that students often focus more on looking skilled than actually being skilled. Many students add multiple skills to their profiles or upload projects they do not fully understand. This creates a situation where presentation becomes more important than real learning.

There is also the ethical issue of misrepresentation. Some students exaggerate their abilities or upload copied or incomplete work just to improve their profile. Even if this is done unintentionally, it is still misleading. Over time, this can damage trust and credibility.

Digital permanence is another major concern. Once something is posted online, it can remain there for a long time. Even if a student

improves later, their earlier mistakes can still affect how others perceive them.

In my opinion, building a digital presence is useful, but only if done honestly and responsibly. Otherwise, it can create more harm than benefit by encouraging superficial learning and false representation.

SECTION C

COLLABORATION VS MISUSE

Digital collaboration tools like Google Docs and shared workspaces have made group work much easier. Students can work together without meeting physically, share ideas instantly, and complete tasks faster. This clearly improves efficiency and teamwork.

However, these platforms also create problems. One major issue is unequal contribution. In many group projects, a few students do most of the work while others contribute very little, yet everyone receives equal credit. Since everything happens online, it becomes difficult to track individual effort.

Another problem is misuse. It is very easy to copy content from the internet and paste it into shared documents. This makes it difficult to distinguish between genuine collaboration and academic dishonesty.

Despite these issues, collaboration tools are still very important. They reflect real-world work environments where teamwork is essential. Banning or limiting these tools is not a practical solution.

The real problem is not the tools, but how they are used. Students need to take responsibility and ensure fair participation. Proper guidelines and awareness can help maintain a balance between collaboration and honesty.

In conclusion, digital collaboration is beneficial, but it must be used carefully to ensure actual learning takes place.

SECTION D

CYBER AWARENESS AND RESPONSIBILITY

Cybercrime has become a serious issue, especially among students who spend a lot of time online. Even though many students are aware of threats like phishing and fraud, these attacks still succeed.

The main reason is that people do not apply their knowledge in real situations. When faced with urgent messages or attractive offers, students often react quickly without verifying details. Scammers take advantage of this behavior by creating a sense of urgency.

This raises the question of responsibility. While users should be careful and think before acting, platforms also play a role. Many platforms are designed to encourage quick responses, which increases the chances of mistakes.

Another issue is that awareness is often theoretical. Students may know about cyber risks, but they are not trained to handle real situations. Knowing something and actually practicing it are different.

Current safety measures like strong passwords and awareness campaigns are helpful, but they are not enough. Real safety comes from developing habits like checking links, verifying sources, and thinking before taking action.

In the end, cyber safety is a shared responsibility. Both users and platforms must work together to reduce risks.

SECTION E

COMMUNICATION AND DIGITAL ETIQUETTE

Communication plays a very important role in digital environments, especially in professional settings. However, many students struggle to communicate properly in emails and formal messages.

One reason is the influence of informal communication. Students are used to chatting on messaging apps, where communication is quick, short, and casual. Over time, this style becomes a habit.

When students use the same style in formal communication, it can appear rude or unprofessional. For example, sending a short or incomplete email without proper structure can create a negative impression.

Another issue is that students often prioritize speed over clarity. They focus on sending messages quickly rather than thinking about how they will be understood by the receiver.

Professional communication is important because it reflects a person's attitude and seriousness. A well-written message shows respect and attention to detail, while a poorly written one can harm opportunities.

Although informal communication is becoming common, professional environments still require a certain level of formality.

Students need to learn when to switch between informal and formal styles.

SECTION F

REFLECTION

Before working on this case study, I believed that digital literacy simply meant knowing how to use digital tools. I thought being able to create presentations or use online platforms was enough.

However, this case study changed my perspective. I realized that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about understanding their impact and using them responsibly.

One thing that surprised me was how small mistakes, like sending an unprofessional email or clicking on a suspicious link, can have serious consequences. It made me reflect on my own habits.

I also realized that I sometimes focus more on speed than accuracy, especially while communicating or browsing online. This can be risky in the long run.

After this case study, I feel that I need to be more careful and aware. I should verify information before trusting it, think before posting anything online, and communicate more professionally.

Overall, I understood that being digitally active is not enough — being digitally responsible is what truly matters.

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